

CloudVault Help Center — Frequently Asked Questions

Account & Billing

Q: How do I create a CloudVault account?

Visit cloudvault.com/signup and enter your email address, a password, and your name to get started. You'll receive a verification email — click the link inside to activate your account. New accounts start on the free Starter plan with 5GB of storage, and you can upgrade to Plus, Pro, or Business at any time from your account settings.

Q: What plans does CloudVault offer?

CloudVault offers four plans: Starter (free, 5GB storage), Plus (\$6.99/month, 200GB storage), Pro (\$14.99/month, 2TB storage), and Business (\$9.99 per user/month, 5TB pooled storage). All paid plans include unlimited Version History and Share Links, while Business adds the CloudVault Admin Console for team management. You can compare full plan details on the Pricing page in your dashboard.

Q: How do I reset my password?

Go to the login screen and click "Forgot password," then enter the email address associated with your account. We'll send a password reset link that's valid for 60 minutes. If you don't see the email within a few minutes, check your spam folder before requesting a new link.

Q: I forgot my password — what should I do?

Click "Forgot password" on the CloudVault login page and enter your account email to receive a reset link. The link expires after 60 minutes, so use it promptly. If you've also lost access to your Encrypted Vaults, you may need your Vault Recovery Key to regain entry to those specific folders.

Q: How do I cancel my subscription?

Open the CloudVault Mobile app or web dashboard, navigate to Account Settings > Billing, and select "Cancel Subscription." Your plan will remain active until the end of the current billing cycle, after which your account reverts to the Starter plan. Any data beyond the 5GB Starter limit will become read-only until you upgrade again or remove files.

Q: Can I get a refund if I cancel CloudVault Plus or Pro?

We offer prorated refunds within 14 days of a new subscription purchase or upgrade. To request one, contact billing@cloudvault.com with your account email and order number. Refunds typically post to your original payment method within 5-7 business days.

Q: How do I upgrade from Plus to Pro?

In the web dashboard, go to Account Settings > Billing and click "Change Plan," then select Pro (2TB, \$14.99/month). The price difference is prorated for the remainder of your current billing cycle and charged immediately. Your additional 1.8TB of storage becomes available right away.

Q: Does CloudVault offer annual billing discounts?

Yes, switching to annual billing on the Plus or Pro plan saves approximately 15% compared to monthly billing. Business plan annual contracts offer custom discounts based on seat count — reach out to sales@cloudvault.com for a quote. You can switch between monthly and annual billing anytime from the Billing tab.

Q: How do I update my payment method?

Go to Account Settings > Billing > Payment Methods and click "Add or Update Card." CloudVault accepts all major credit cards as well as PayPal. Your new payment method will be used automatically for the next billing cycle.

Q: What happens to my files if my payment fails?

If a payment fails, we'll retry the charge three times over seven days and notify you by email each time. If payment still fails, your account is downgraded to Starter, and any files beyond the 5GB limit become read-only (but are not deleted) for 30 days while you resolve billing. After 30 days of inactivity on a downgraded account, standard data retention policies apply.

Setup & Installation

Q: How do I install the CloudVault Sync desktop client?

Download CloudVault Sync from cloudvault.com/download for Windows, macOS, or Linux. Run the installer and sign in with your CloudVault account credentials when prompted. Once installed, a CloudVault folder will appear on your device, and any files placed inside it sync automatically to your account.

Q: Where can I download the CloudVault Mobile app?

CloudVault Mobile is available on the Apple App Store for iOS and the Google Play Store for Android. Search "CloudVault" and look for the official listing with the green vault icon. After installing, sign in with the same credentials you use on the desktop client and web dashboard.

Q: How do I set up CloudVault on a new computer?

Install CloudVault Sync from cloudvault.com/download and log in with your existing account. During setup, you can choose to sync all folders or select specific ones to save local disk space. Your files will begin downloading immediately, and progress is shown in the Sync status panel.

Q: I just got a new laptop — how do I get my files back?

Install CloudVault Sync on the new laptop and sign in with your CloudVault account. Choose "Sync all folders" during setup, and your existing files, including Version History, will download automatically. Depending on your storage size and connection speed, the initial sync may take anywhere from a few minutes to a few hours.

Q: How do I migrate my files from Dropbox or Google Drive?

Use Vault Migrate, our built-in migration tool, available under Settings > Import in the web dashboard. Connect your Dropbox or Google Drive account, select the folders you want to bring over, and Vault Migrate will copy them into CloudVault while preserving folder structure. Large migrations run in the background, and you'll get an email notification when the transfer completes.

Q: Can I choose which folders sync to my computer?

Yes, open CloudVault Sync, click the icon in your system tray or menu bar, and select "Preferences > Selective Sync." From there you can check or uncheck individual folders to control what downloads locally. Unchecked folders remain safely stored in the cloud and can be synced later at any time.

Q: What are the minimum system requirements for CloudVault Sync?

CloudVault Sync requires Windows 10 or later, macOS 11 or later, or a modern 64-bit Linux distribution. You'll need at least 2GB of RAM and enough free disk space to accommodate any folders you choose to sync locally. An active internet connection is required for syncing, though offline edits are queued and uploaded once you're back online.

Q: How do I set up two-factor authentication during account setup?

After creating your account, go to Account Settings > Security and click "Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)." Scan the QR code with an authenticator app like Google Authenticator or Authy, then enter the 6-digit code to confirm setup. We strongly recommend enabling 2FA immediately, especially if you plan to use Encrypted Vaults.

Q: My CloudVault Sync installation is stuck — what should I do?

First, ensure you're connected to the internet and that your firewall isn't blocking CloudVault Sync. Restart the installer, and if it remains stuck at the same step, uninstall any partial installation files and download a fresh installer from cloudvault.com/download. If the issue persists, contact support with your operating system version and installer log.

Q: Do I need to install anything to use CloudVault, or can I use it in a browser?

You can use CloudVault entirely through the web dashboard at app.cloudvault.com without installing anything. However, installing CloudVault Sync enables automatic background syncing and offline file access, which most users find more convenient for everyday use. The CloudVault Mobile app is also optional but useful for on-the-go access.

Features & Usage

Q: What is Version History and how do I use it?

Version History automatically saves previous versions of your files every time they're edited, so you can restore an earlier copy if needed. Right-click any file in the web dashboard or CloudVault Sync folder and select "View Version History" to see a timeline of saved versions. Plus and Pro plans retain up to 180 days of history, while Business retains a full 365 days.

Q: How do I create a Share Link for a file or folder?

Right-click the file or folder you want to share and select "Create Share Link." You can set an optional expiration date, require a password, and choose whether recipients can view-only or also edit, depending on your plan. The generated link can be copied and sent to anyone, even if they don't have a CloudVault account.

Q: How do I share a file with someone who doesn't use CloudVault?

Use a Share Link — right-click the file, choose "Create Share Link," and copy the generated URL to send via email or chat. The recipient can view or download the file directly in their browser without needing a CloudVault account. You can revoke the link at any time from the Sharing tab.

Q: What is an Encrypted Vault?

An Encrypted Vault is a special folder protected with end-to-end encryption, meaning only you (and people you explicitly grant access to) can decrypt and view its contents. To create one, go to the dashboard and select "New Encrypted Vault," then set a vault password separate from your account password. CloudVault never stores your vault password or has the ability to decrypt vault contents on our servers.

Q: How do I recover files from an Encrypted Vault if I forget the vault password?

You'll need your Vault Recovery Key, a unique code generated when you first created the Encrypted Vault, to regain access. Enter the Vault Recovery Key on the vault unlock screen to reset your vault password without losing data. If you've lost both the password and the Recovery Key, CloudVault cannot decrypt the vault contents, as we never store this information.

Q: How much storage do I have, and how can I check my usage?

You can check your current storage usage anytime under Account Settings > Storage in the web dashboard or CloudVault Mobile app. It shows a breakdown by file type and folder, along with your plan's total limit. Plus includes 200GB, Pro includes 2TB, and Business includes 5TB pooled across all team members.

Q: Can multiple people edit the same document at once?

Yes, CloudVault supports real-time collaborative editing for documents, spreadsheets, and presentations created within the platform. Each collaborator's cursor and edits appear live, and changes are automatically saved to Version History. You can invite collaborators by sharing the file with edit permissions.

Q: How do I restore a deleted file?

Open the "Trash" folder in your web dashboard or CloudVault Sync client, find the deleted file, and click "Restore." Deleted files remain in Trash for 30 days on Plus and Pro plans, and 90 days on Business, after which they're permanently removed. You can also restore individual file versions directly from Version History if a file was overwritten rather than deleted.

Q: What's the maximum file size I can upload to CloudVault?

Starter and Plus plans support individual file uploads up to 10GB, while Pro and Business support files up to 100GB. Larger files are automatically split into chunks during upload for reliability, so interrupted uploads can resume without starting over. This applies to uploads through the web dashboard, CloudVault Sync, and CloudVault Mobile.

Q: How do I organize files into folders and tags?

You can create nested folders just like a regular file system, and additionally apply custom tags (like "Tax2026" or "Client-Acme") to files for quick filtering. Tags appear in the sidebar of the web dashboard, and clicking one filters your view across all folders instantly. This is especially useful for Business accounts managing large shared drives.

Troubleshooting

Q: My files aren't syncing — what should I check first?

First, confirm CloudVault Sync is running and check the sync status icon in your system tray or menu bar for error indicators. Make sure you have an active internet connection and sufficient free storage on your plan, since a full quota will pause uploads. If the icon shows a sync error, click it for details on the specific file causing the issue.

Q: CloudVault Sync says "Sync paused" — how do I fix it?

Sync is commonly paused due to insufficient local disk space, a full storage quota, or a lost internet connection. Open CloudVault Sync, click the status icon, and review the error message for the specific cause. Once you've freed up space or resolved the connection issue, click "Resume Sync" to continue.

Q: Why is CloudVault Sync running slowly on my computer?

Slow performance is often caused by syncing a very large number of small files at once, limited bandwidth, or background system processes competing for resources. Try pausing sync temporarily under Preferences, then resume it, or use Selective Sync to reduce the number of folders syncing simultaneously. If the issue continues, check for a pending CloudVault Sync update under Help > Check for Updates.

Q: I can't log into my CloudVault account — what should I do?

Double-check that you're entering the correct email and password, and confirm Caps Lock isn't affecting your password entry. If you've enabled Two-Factor Authentication (2FA), make sure your authenticator app's time is synced correctly, since codes are time-sensitive. If you still can't log in, use the "Forgot password" link or contact support@cloudvault.com.

Q: A Share Link I created isn't working for the recipient.

First, verify the link hasn't expired or been manually revoked from the Sharing tab in your dashboard. If the Share Link requires a password, confirm you shared that password separately with the recipient, since it isn't included in the link itself. Also check that the file wasn't moved into an Encrypted Vault, as vault contents cannot be shared via standard Share Links.

Q: Why does my upload keep failing or getting stuck?

Large or numerous file uploads can fail due to unstable internet connections, antivirus software interference, or reaching your plan's storage limit. Try pausing and resuming the upload, or restart CloudVault Sync to clear any stuck processes. If problems persist, check Account Settings > Storage to confirm you haven't exceeded your plan's quota.

Q: The CloudVault Mobile app keeps crashing — how do I fix it?

Start by force-closing the app and reopening it, then check the App Store or Google Play Store for any pending updates. If crashes continue, try uninstalling and reinstalling CloudVault Mobile, which clears any corrupted local cache without affecting your cloud-stored files. Make sure your device's operating system is also up to date.

Q: I'm missing a file that I'm sure I uploaded — where did it go?

Check the Trash folder first, since accidental deletions are recoverable there for 30 days on Plus and Pro, or 90 days on Business. Next, use the search bar in the web dashboard to confirm the file wasn't simply moved to a different folder. If you still can't locate it, check Version History on the parent folder, as a sync conflict may have renamed the file.

Q: I'm getting an "Encrypted Vault locked" error — what does that mean?

This error appears when your vault session has timed out for security reasons or when an incorrect vault password was entered too many times. Re-enter your correct vault password to unlock it, or use your Vault Recovery Key if you've forgotten the password. Repeated failed attempts may trigger a short cooldown period before you can try again.

Q: CloudVault Sync isn't starting up on my computer at all.

Try restarting your computer first, as this resolves most startup issues caused by conflicting background processes. If the client still won't launch, uninstall it completely and reinstall the latest version from cloudvault.com/download. Make sure your operating system meets the minimum system requirements, particularly on older machines.

Integrations

Q: Does CloudVault integrate with Microsoft Office?

Yes, CloudVault offers a Microsoft Office plug-in that lets you open, edit, and save Word, Excel, and PowerPoint files directly from CloudVault storage without manual downloading. Install it from Settings > Integrations in the web dashboard, then sign in with your CloudVault credentials inside Office. Changes save back to CloudVault automatically, with each save creating a new entry in Version History.

Q: Can I migrate my data from Google Drive automatically?

Yes, use Vault Migrate under Settings > Import to connect your Google Drive account and select folders to transfer. Vault Migrate preserves your original folder structure and file metadata during the move. You'll receive an email notification once the migration finishes, which can take anywhere from minutes to hours depending on data size.

Q: Does CloudVault have a Slack integration?

Yes, the CloudVault Slack integration lets you share Share Links directly into Slack channels and receive notifications when files are shared with your workspace. Install it from the Slack App Directory or from Settings > Integrations in your CloudVault dashboard. Business plan admins can manage workspace-wide Slack connections from the CloudVault Admin Console.

Q: How do I connect CloudVault to my Dropbox account for migration?

Open Vault Migrate under Settings > Import, select Dropbox as the source, and authorize CloudVault to access your Dropbox account. Choose the specific folders you'd like imported, and Vault Migrate handles the transfer in the background. Your original Dropbox files remain untouched, so nothing is deleted from the source account.

Q: Can I use CloudVault with Zapier?

Yes, CloudVault has an official Zapier integration that lets you automate workflows, such as automatically creating a Share Link whenever a new file is uploaded to a specific folder. Connect it by searching "CloudVault" in the Zapier app directory and authorizing your account. This is available on Plus, Pro, and Business plans.

Q: Does CloudVault support single sign-on (SSO) for businesses?

Business plan accounts support SSO through SAML 2.0, compatible with identity providers like Okta, Azure AD, and Google Workspace. Admins configure SSO from the CloudVault Admin Console under Security Settings. Once enabled, team members sign in using their existing company credentials instead of separate CloudVault passwords.

Q: Is there a CloudVault API for developers?

Yes, the CloudVault API allows developers to programmatically upload, download, and manage files, as well as create Share Links and monitor storage usage. API access is available on Pro and Business plans, with documentation available at developers.cloudvault.com. Authentication uses OAuth 2.0 tokens generated from your account's Developer Settings.

Q: Can I back up my CloudVault files to another service?

While CloudVault doesn't offer automatic export to other cloud providers, you can manually download files or entire folders as a ZIP archive from the web dashboard. For larger ongoing backup needs, the CloudVault API can be used to build a custom export workflow. Encrypted Vault contents must be unlocked before they can be downloaded or exported.

Q: Does CloudVault work with Adobe Creative Cloud apps?

Yes, CloudVault Sync integrates with Adobe Creative Cloud applications like Photoshop and Illustrator by allowing you to save and open files directly from your synced CloudVault folder. Because these files exist in your local CloudVault Sync directory, changes are automatically uploaded and versioned like any other synced file. No separate plug-in installation is required for this basic file-level integration.

Q: How do I set up the CloudVault integration with Google Workspace?

Go to Settings > Integrations and select Google Workspace, then authorize the connection with your Google admin account. This enables single sign-on for Business plan users and allows direct creation of Google Docs, Sheets, and Slides that sync into your CloudVault folders. Admins can manage and revoke this integration anytime from the CloudVault Admin Console.

Security & Privacy

Q: How does CloudVault protect my data?

All files are encrypted in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher and encrypted at rest using AES-256 encryption on our servers. For an additional layer of protection, Encrypted Vaults provide end-to-end encryption that even CloudVault staff cannot access. We also perform regular third-party security audits to ensure our infrastructure meets industry standards.

Q: What is Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) and how do I enable it?

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) adds a second verification step at login, typically a 6-digit code from an authenticator app, in addition to your password. Enable it under Account Settings > Security by scanning the provided QR code with an app like Google Authenticator or Authy. We strongly recommend enabling 2FA for all accounts, especially those using Encrypted Vaults or Business plan admin access.

Q: Can CloudVault employees access my files?

For standard storage, a small number of authorized CloudVault employees can access files only when necessary for support requests you've initiated, and all such access is logged. Files stored in Encrypted Vaults are end-to-end encrypted, meaning CloudVault has no technical ability to view their contents under any circumstances. We never sell or share your file contents with third parties.

Q: How do I know if my account has been compromised?

Check Account Settings > Security > Login History to review recent sign-ins, including device type, location, and timestamp. If you notice unfamiliar activity, change your password immediately and enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) if you haven't already. You can also remotely sign out all active sessions from the same Security page.

Q: What should I do if I suspect unauthorized access to my account?

Immediately change your password from Account Settings > Security and enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) if it isn't already active. Use the "Sign out all devices" option to terminate any active sessions you don't recognize. Then contact security@cloudvault.com so our team can investigate further and help secure your account.

Q: Does CloudVault comply with GDPR?

Yes, CloudVault is fully GDPR-compliant for users and businesses operating in the European Union, including support for data access requests and the right to erasure. You can request a full export or deletion of your personal data from Account Settings > Privacy. Our data processing agreements are available upon request for Business plan customers.

Q: Where are CloudVault's servers located, and can I choose a region?

CloudVault operates data centers in North America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific to ensure fast access and regional compliance. Business plan customers can select a preferred storage region under Admin Console > Data Residency Settings. Standard Plus and Pro accounts are automatically assigned to the nearest available region based on sign-up location.

Q: How do Encrypted Vaults differ from regular CloudVault storage in terms of privacy?

Regular CloudVault storage is encrypted at rest and in transit, but CloudVault retains the ability to decrypt files for features like search indexing and support access. Encrypted Vaults use end-to-end encryption with a separate vault password, meaning the encryption keys never leave your device and CloudVault cannot decrypt vault contents under any circumstances. This makes Encrypted Vaults ideal for highly sensitive documents.

Q: Can I see who has accessed a Share Link I created?

Yes, open the Sharing tab and select "View Link Activity" on any Share Link to see access timestamps and, if available, general location data of viewers. This helps you monitor whether a link has been accessed by unintended recipients. You can revoke the link instantly from the same screen if needed.

Q: What happens to my data if I delete my CloudVault account?

When you delete your account from Account Settings > Privacy > Delete Account, all your files, including Version History and Encrypted Vault contents, are scheduled for permanent deletion within 30 days. This 30-day window exists in case the deletion was accidental, and you can cancel it by logging back in during that period. After 30 days, data is irrecoverably purged from our servers in accordance with our data retention policy.